



Mercedes-Benz

Press Information

July 24, 2025

Triple Score in Efficiency: Mercedes-Benz VLE succeeds in next major development steps

- VLE prototypes proved outstanding performance in three disciplines of efficiency tests
- In the wind tunnel, the VLE demonstrated its aerodynamics in sustained gale and storm conditions
- On the track in Nardò, efficiency was optimised under extremely dynamic handling, and at high speeds
- From Stuttgart to Rome, the VLE showed the efficiency of the new Van Electric Architecture on a long-range journey

In 2026, the all-electric VLE will hit the roads and mark the beginning of a new era at Mercedes-Benz Vans. With up to eight seats, the VLE portfolio will range from flexible vehicles for families and leisure active customers, to exclusive VIP shuttles. As added value for customers is key for Mercedes-Benz, the future VLE will suit perfectly the customers' needs and demands, in terms of design, functions and usability. Bringing the best of two worlds together, the all-electric VLE combines limousine-like driving behaviour with MPV-like versatility.

Now, prototypes of the VLE successfully passed the next major steps in the development program by proving its uncompromising efficiency in three different disciplines:

First: Proof of aerodynamics in wind tunnel

In gruelling tests in the Mercedes-Benz wind tunnel in Stuttgart, the VLE braved the fiercest winds. The VLE showcased that the exterior design with a tautly stretched roofline flowing into the smoothly rounded rear, leads to an impressive drag coefficient. And although the prototypes were heavily camouflaged with different extensions in the exterior to secure the streamlined silhouette of the VLE, the results of the aerodynamics test were outstanding in terms of efficiency.

Second: High-speed drives at test track

At the test track in Nardò, Southern Italy, the Mercedes-Benz experts increased efficiency by fine-tuning under extremely dynamic handling and at high speeds. The primary objective was to optimise the settings of the electric drivetrain, along with refining recuperation processes, enhancing thermal management, and assessing the impact of rear axle steering on vehicle handling.

Third: Long-range journey from Stuttgart to Rome

Recently, the Mercedes-Benz VLE successfully underwent a long-range journey by traveling almost 1,100 kilometres from Stuttgart to Rome with only two short charging stops of 15 minutes each. The focus was to demonstrate the suitability for daily use on different road types and conditions for travel by families and leisure enthusiasts. ([Link Media Site](#))

New Era

Starting in 2026, the VLE will be the first model based on the newly developed, modular, and scalable van architecture – ushering in a completely new era. This architecture allows for a clear differentiation between privately positioned Grand Limousines – the Mercedes-Benz VLE and the Mercedes-Benz VLS – and commercial transporters. While the VLE with up to 8 seats will range from flexible vehicles for families and leisure active customers to exclusive VIP shuttles, the VLS will expand the Mercedes-Benz MPV portfolio into the top-end-segment.

Contact:

Ralph Wagenknecht, +49 (0) 160 86 58 077, ralph.wagenknecht@mercedes-benz.com

Florian Hofmann, +49 (0) 160 86 93 546, florian.hofmann@mercedes-benz.com

Benjamin Oberkersch, +49 151 58 62 00 19, benjamin.oberkersch@mercedes-benz.com

Further information about **Mercedes-Benz** is available at www.mercedes-benz.com and on our **LinkedIn** channel under [Mercedes-Benz AG | LinkedIn](#).

Press information and digital services for journalists and multipliers can be found on our **Mercedes-Benz Media** online platform at media.mercedes-benz.com.

Mercedes-Benz AG at a glance

Mercedes-Benz AG is part of the Mercedes-Benz Group AG with a total of around 175,000 employees worldwide and is responsible for the global business of Mercedes-Benz Cars and Mercedes-Benz Vans. Ola Källenius is Chairman of the Board of Management of Mercedes-Benz AG. The company focuses on the development, production and sales of passenger cars, vans and vehicle-related services. Furthermore, the company aspires to be the leader in the fields of electric mobility and vehicle software. The product portfolio comprises the Mercedes-Benz brand with Mercedes-AMG, Mercedes-Maybach and G-Class with their all-electric models as well as products of the smart brand. Mercedes-Benz AG is one of the world's largest manufacturers of high-end passenger cars. In 2024 it sold around 2,4 million passenger cars and vans. In its two business segments, Mercedes-Benz AG is continually expanding its worldwide production network with more than 30 production sites on four continents, while gearing itself to meet the requirements of electric mobility. At the same time, the company is constructing and extending its global battery production network on three continents. As sustainability is the guiding principle of the Mercedes-Benz strategy and for the company itself, this means creating lasting value for all stakeholders: for customers, employees, investors, business partners and society as a whole. The basis for this is the sustainable business strategy of the Mercedes-Benz Group. The company thus takes responsibility for the economic, ecological and social effects of its business activities and looks at the entire value chain.